HTTP Status Codes Cheat Sheet

A quick guide for API developers

Easy way to remember

Range	Meaning
2xx	It worked
3xx	Go somewhere else
4xx	You made a mistake (client error)
5xx	I made a mistake (server error)

Most important 8 codes

If you learn only these 8, you cover about 95% of real work. Close behind: 204, 429, 503.

Code	Name	When to use
200	OK	The request succeeded (your /predict)
201	Created	A new resource was created (POST that saves data)
400	Bad Request	The request is malformed or logically wrong
401	Unauthorized	Not logged in, or token / API key missing or invalid
403	Forbidden	Logged in, but not allowed to do this
404	Not Found	The resource or URL doesn't exist
422	Unprocessable Entity	JSON is valid but values fail validation (FastAPI default)
500	Internal Server Error	A bug or crash on the server

20 important status codes

Code	Name	Meaning
101	Switching Protocols	Upgrading to WebSocket
200	OK	Standard success
201	Created	New resource created; usually with a Location header
202	Accepted	Received; will be processed later (background jobs)
204	No Content	Success with no body; typical for DELETE
301	Moved Permanently	The URL has changed permanently
302	Found	Temporary redirect

Code	Name	Meaning
304	Not Modified	The cached copy is still valid
307	Temporary Redirect	Like 302, but keeps the HTTP method
308	Permanent Redirect	Like 301, but keeps the HTTP method
400	Bad Request	Invalid or malformed request
401	Unauthorized	Authentication required or failed
403	Forbidden	Authenticated, but no permission
404	Not Found	The resource doesn't exist
405	Method Not Allowed	Wrong HTTP verb, e.g. GET on a POST-only route
409	Conflict	Conflicts with current state, e.g. duplicate email
422	Unprocessable Entity	Data fails validation
429	Too Many Requests	Rate limit hit
500	Internal Server Error	Unexpected failure
503	Service Unavailable	Server is up but can't serve now (model not loaded, overloaded, maintenance)

Also worth knowing: **502 Bad Gateway** and **504 Gateway Timeout**, which come from proxies and load balancers.

Common confusions

Pair	Difference
401 vs 403	401 = "who are you?" (no valid login). 403 = "I know who you are, but you can't do this."
400 vs 422	400 = request is broken, e.g. invalid JSON. 422 = JSON is fine but a value is wrong, e.g. bedrooms: -5.
500 vs 503	500 = something broke unexpectedly. 503 = a known, temporary unavailability.